

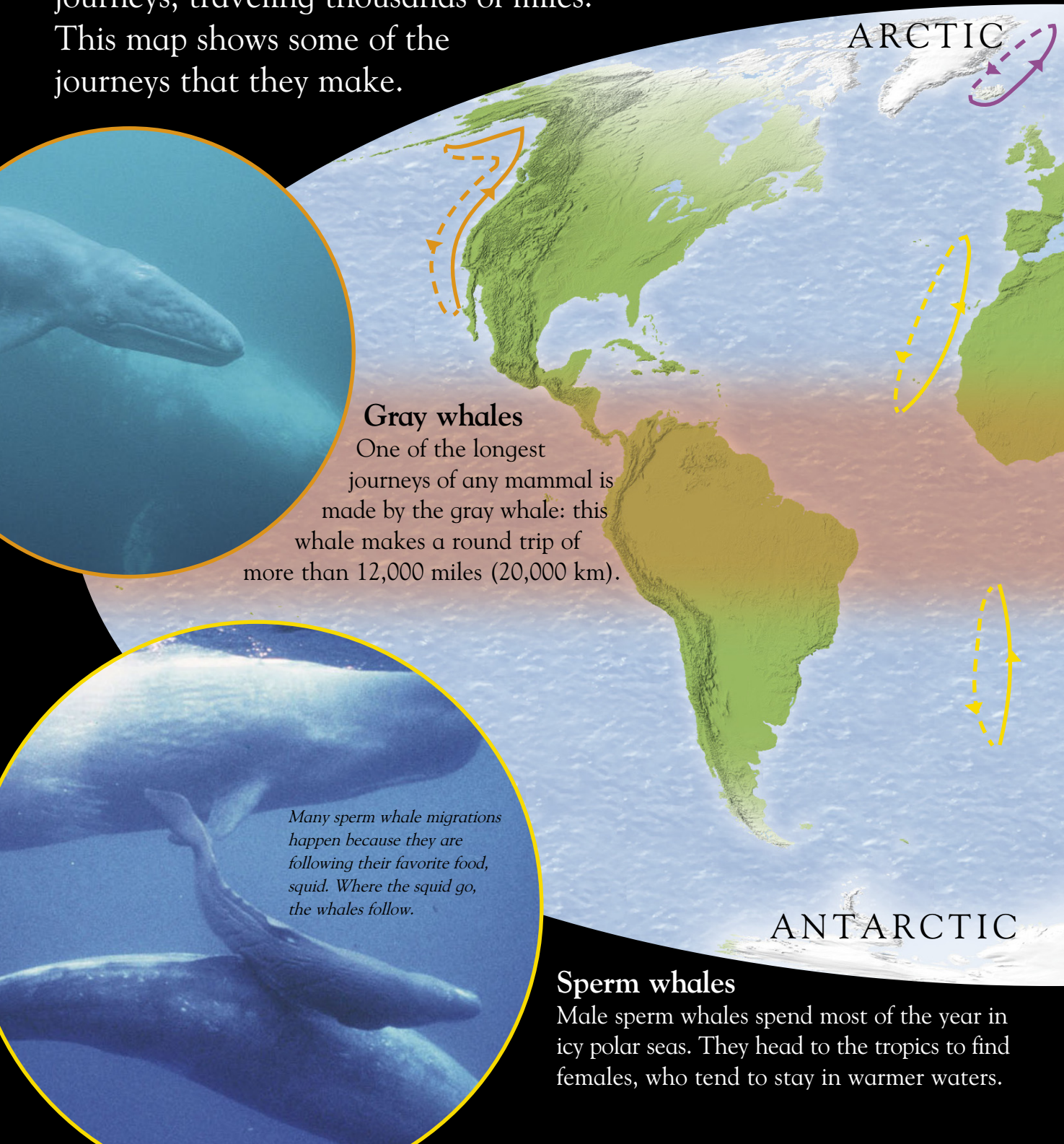
On the move

Many whales move, or migrate, to find food or to find a mate. Some make amazing journeys, traveling thousands of miles.

This map shows some of the journeys that they make.

Which way?

Whales use ocean currents, Earth's magnetic field, the seabed, and the position of the Sun to help them find their way.



Gray whales

One of the longest journeys of any mammal is made by the gray whale: this whale makes a round trip of more than 12,000 miles (20,000 km).

Many sperm whale migrations happen because they are following their favorite food, squid. Where the squid go, the whales follow.

Sperm whales

Male sperm whales spend most of the year in icy polar seas. They head to the tropics to find females, who tend to stay in warmer waters.